

By 2020, AI to create more jobs than it eliminates

Artificial intelligence (AI) will create 2.3 million jobs in 2020, while eliminating 1.8 million—according to Gartner. The number of jobs affected by AI will vary by industry; through 2019, healthcare, public sector and education will see continuously growing job demand while manufacturing will be hit the hardest. Starting in 2020, AI-related job creation will cross into positive territory, reaching two million net-new jobs in 2025.

AI will improve the productivity of many jobs, eliminating millions of middle- and low-level positions, while also creating millions of more

new positions at highly skilled, management and even the entry level and low-skilled levels.

The Gartner report suggests that IT leaders should not focus only on the projected net increase of jobs. With each investment in AI-enabled technologies, they must take into consideration what jobs will be lost, what jobs will be created, and how it will transform the way workers collaborate with others, make decisions and get work done. As regards AI's impact on the workplace, the report predicts that by 2022, one in five workers engaged in mostly non-routine tasks will rely on AI.

On The Move

Ajay appointed secretary, MoD

Dr Ajay Kumar, additional secretary in Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, has been elevated to secretary in ministry of Defence. Kumar is a 1985-batch IAS officer of Kerala cadre.

Apple's India chief quits

Apple's chief of operations for India Sanjay Kaul has decided to step down from his role at the company, according to a report from Reuters. He has been replaced with a long-time executive, Michel Coulomb.

Semiconductor equipment to break sales record

Worldwide sales of new semiconductor manufacturing equipment will increase 35.6 per cent to \$55.9 billion in 2017, exceeding its previous high of \$47.7 billion in 2000—according to SEMI, global industry association representing the electronics manufacturing supply chain. Year 2018 will break another record with 7.5 per cent

growth resulting in sales of \$60.1 billion.

SEMI predicts a 37.5 per cent increase in 2017, to \$45.0 billion, for wafer processing equipment. The other front-end segment, which consists of fab facilities equipment, wafer manufacturing and mask/reticle equipment, is expected to increase 45.8 per cent to \$2.6 billion. The assembly and packag-

ing equipment are projected to grow by 25.8 per cent to \$3.8 billion in 2017, while semiconductor test equipment are forecast to increase by 22 per cent to \$4.5 billion.

In 2017, South Korea will be the largest equipment market for the first time. After maintaining the top spot for five years, Taiwan will rank second, followed by China.

Rooftop PV presents a \$23 billion opportunity in India

India will need to invest \$23 billion over the next five years to meet its 40GW rooftop photovoltaics target for year 2022, according to a new report by Bloomberg New Energy Finance (BNEF).

The Indian government has set its sights on having 175GW of non-hydro renewables capacity by 2022. At present, this figure stands at just 60GW. The majority of the capacity in the 2022 target—a total of 135GW—is utility-scale (wind farms and solar

parks, in particular) and does not include large hydro projects. The report estimates that India will need to invest \$83 billion to build this capacity. The good news is that, because of falling capital costs per MW, that figure is \$19 billion less than in BNEF's previous estimates.

Some of the most interesting activity will be in small-scale solar. Shantanu Jaiswal, head of India research at Bloomberg New Energy Finance, said: "Rooftop solar in India

will grow inevitably with or without the support of power distribution utilities."

The cost of electricity from rooftop PV has halved in the last five years due to fierce competition in the market and a drop in equipment prices. In contrast, average retail electricity rates have increased by 22 per cent in the same period. This has made rooftop PV cheaper than commercial and industrial grid tariffs in all major states of India.